

Apple System Settings

Category	Mac	iPad	iPhone	Cosmetic	Informational	Security	Privacy	Description
Apple Account	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	• Sign in or sign out of your Apple Account • Enable features like Find My Mac, iCloud Drive, and Photos sync • Manage iCloud storage
Family	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	• Share access to subscriptions, purchases, and more with your Family Sharing group. Adults can also set up child accounts and manage parental controls.
Airplane Mode	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Turn on & off wi-fi, bluetooth, and cellular reception collectively with one toggle control.
Wi-Fi	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Connect and manage networks • Copy the network password if previously connected
Bluetooth	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Manage Bluetooth settings • Pair devices
Network	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Set up and manage Wi-Fi, Ethernet, Thunderbolt, firewall, and other network services.
Cellular	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Turn cellular data and roaming on/off • Set which apps and services use cellular data • Set other cellular data options
Personal Hotspot	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Share the internet connection from your iPhone with other devices
VPN	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	• See VPN service configurations • You can also modify settings for VPN connections you have here—although I recommend you do that using your VPN client’s app settings instead
Battery	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Track your Battery health, charging, and usage statistics • Customize energy-saving settings
General > About	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	• See information about your device: processor (CPU) type, size of memory (RAM) and storage (local; not cloud drives), operating system version, etc
General > Software Update	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• See which operating system version is installed on your device • Control whether or not updates are installed automatically • Manually start an update if any are pending
General > Storage	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• See how much of your local storage is currently in use and how the space is used (e.g., by file type and/or by app)
General > iPad Storage	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• See how much of your local storage is currently in use and how the space is used (e.g., by file type and/or by app) • Offload (i.e., uninstall) unused apps • Review and delete large files attached to Message app texts
General > iPhone Storage	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• See how much of your local storage is currently in use and how the space is used (e.g., by file type and/or by app) • Offload (i.e., uninstall) unused apps • Review and delete large files attached to Message app texts
General > AppleCare & Warranty	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• View device’s warranty and AppleCare status • Purchase additional coverage for eligible devices • <u>Note</u>: You will see all your devices here regardless of which device you are using to view this Settings category
General > AirDrop & Continuity	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Use AirDrop & Continuity settings to start something on one Apple device and hand it off to another, send files to Apple devices near you with AirDrop, or allow other devices to stream content to your Mac with AirPlay Receiver. • Controls for Mirroring and AirPlay are found here

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General > AirDrop	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- AirDrop allows you to transfer files wirelessly between Apple devices (yours and other people's) - Controls in this Settings category allow you to - Restrict who can share files with you via AirDrop - Disable AirDrop through cellular internet connections (i.e., restrict cellular data use)
General > AirPlay & Continuity	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Manage how your iPad connects and interacts with other Apple devices for streaming content and sharing tasks - You can adjust settings for AirPlay, which lets you stream audio and video to compatible devices, and Continuity features that enable seamless transitions between your Apple devices.
General > Picture in Picture	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Turn “picture-in-picture” on and off - When turned on and you are using videos and FaceTime calls will automatically continue in picture-in-picture when you swipe up on the screen
General > Screen Capture	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	A single toggle control that allows you to chose whether screenshots are briefly displayed as thumbnails in the lower left hand corner of the screen or as full screen views
General > CarPlay	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	Customize how your iPhone interacts with your car's infotainment system, including rearranging app icons, adjusting audio settings, and managing connections
General > AutoFill & Passwords	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Customize how your iPhone interacts with your car's CarPlay system, including rearranging app icons, adjusting audio settings, and managing connections Note: You have to pair your iPhone with your car's CarPlay system <u>before</u> you can make any settings changes in this category
General > Background App Refresh	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Disable/enable which of your apps refresh in the background in this category. - Some apps keep running in the background even when you're not using them. While handy for things like email, too many can slow performance and drain battery.
General > Date & Time	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Control whether or not your device sets the date & time automatically using an internet time service - Set the timezone for your device - Set the format dates & times are shown
General > Dictionary	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	Add / remove additional languages (e.g., Spanish, French, German, etc) to the system's dictionary service
General > Fonts	✗	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	View the fonts that are installed on your device.
General > Keyboard	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Configure your device's <u>virtual</u> (i.e., on screen keyboard; you can connect physical keyboards to iPads & iPhone; this setting control panel does not influence external keyboards) - There are a number of options available. e.g., you can turn on/off predictive text and auto-correct, etc) - Add & delete keyboards for different languages (e.g., French, Spanish, German, etc)
General > Language & Region	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Set the language you want shown - Select the formats used to show dates, times, numbers, etc
General > TV Provider	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- TV/cable providers often provide some Internet streaming services - This control panel allows you to sign in to your TV/cable provider account - Once signed in, you can access the Internet streaming services included with your TV/cable provider. E.g., I have HBO in my cable subscription service; by signing into my cable subscription account in this Settings control panel, I can access HBO content using the HBO app on my iPhone & iPad.
General > VPN & Device Management	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Install, view, or remove VPN and device configuration profiles. - Configuration profiles are files that standardize settings for iPhone and iPad devices, Mac computers, Apple TV 4K, and Apple Watch. Note: This Setting category is of very little use/value to consumer users; it is primarily used in corporate environments
General > Legal & Regulatory	✗	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	View legal and regulatory documentation Apple is required by law to include on mobile devices

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General > Login Items & Extensions	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Select the apps, documents, and server connections that open automatically when you log in to your Mac - Turn Apple and third-party extensions on and off for your Mac - Select extensions to include in the Share menu
General > Sharing	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	Set options for sharing your computer, files, printers, media, etc
General > Startup Disk	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Select the disk drive that contains the OS; your Mac will use this disk to load the OS when you turn on your device - By default, Mac will be configured to use the drive “built in” to your device <u>Note</u>: This Setting category is of very little use/value to consumer users; it is primarily used in corporate environments
General > Time Machine	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Allows you to configure macOS’s backup service (i.e., Time Machine) - You can define which drive is used by Time Machine to store your backups - You can configure Time Machine to automatically backup your device every hour, day, or week
General > Device Management	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Install, view, or remove configuration profiles. - Configuration profiles are files that standardize settings for iPhone and iPad devices, Mac computers, Apple TV 4K, and Apple Watch. <u>Note</u>: This Setting category is of very little use/value to consumer users; it is primarily used in corporate environments
General > Transfer or Reset	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Transfer your documents, apps, user accounts, and settings to your Mac from another Mac or PC, or from a Time Machine backup - Erase all the content and settings on your Mac <u>Note</u>: These settings are typically used when you purchase a new device and/or are getting rid of an existing device.
General > Transfer or Reset iPad	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Transfer your documents, apps, user accounts, and settings to your iPad from another iPad <u>Note</u>: These settings are typically used when you purchase a new device and/or are getting rid of an existing device.
General > Transfer or Reset iPhone	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Transfer your documents, apps, user accounts, and settings to your iPhone from another iPhone <u>Note</u>: These settings are typically used when you purchase a new device and/or are getting rid of an existing device.
General > Shut Down	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	Allows you to turn off your device
Accessibility	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Customize your Mac in ways that work best for you with accessibility features for vision, hearing, mobility, speech, and cognition
Apple Pencil	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Configure the following Apple Pencil behaviors: - Limit use of fingers to scrolling - Allow device to convert your handwriting to text when writing in a text area - Define Pencil Gestures for bottom left and bottom right corners of the screen
Camera	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Configure the following camera behaviors: - Video & Slo-mo resolution & refresh rates - Composition grid, level, and mirror front camera - Automatically improve photos of scenes using intelligent (i.e., “AI”) image recognition - Correct lens distortion - Open the camera from the Lock Screen - Automatically save images taken in Message Camera to the Photo app Library
Control Center	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	Choose what shows in the Menu Bar (like battery percentage, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi).

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Display & Brightness	✗	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	- Configure display appearance - Change Liquid Glass style (i.e., “clear” or “tinted”) - Control the screen’s brightness - Configure “Night Shift” (automatically shifts to a warmer color spectrum after dark; you can also configure the “degree” of warmth) iPad only: Configure if your device locks/unlocks when you use a “smart” cover iPhone only: Set the period of time until your device lock’s itself iPhone only: Enable/disable whether your device wakes up when you pick the device up iPhone only: increase the size of text/controls
Home Screen & App Library	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Make app icons on home screen large - Choose whether the App Library and recently used apps are included in the Doc - Choose if notification badges are shown in the App Library
Multitasking & Gestures	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Choose if apps open in full screen mode, windows apps mode, or Stage Manager mode - Turn on/off “productivity gestures” (e.g., double-tap with three fingers to undo; swipe left with three fingers to undo; swipe right with three fingers to redo; etc.)
Search	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Control which apps are included Spotlight searches - Chose whether you see recent searches in the Spotlight search box - Chose whether content from Apple and its business partners are included in Spotlight search results
Siri	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Customize some Siri behaviors e.g., trigger phrase, keyboard shortcut trigger, language, voice style, etc) - Control which individual apps are included in Spotlight search results Note: If your device supports Apple Intelligence, you will not see the Apple Intelligence... category instead a category named Siri
Standby	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Normally when your phone is connected to a charger, the screen will turn off (i.e., go to sleep) after a few moments - You can configure your phone so that the screen shows you the date and time when your phone is leaned upright on its long side - This control panel allows you to enable/disable this behavior - You can also chose whether you see notifications in this mode
Appearance	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	- Switch between Light, Dark, or Auto Mode - Change accent and highlight colors - Adjust sidebar icon sizes - Adjust scrollbar visibility & behaviors
Apple Intelligence...	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Turn Apple Intelligence features on & off - Turn Siri on & off - Customize some Siri behaviors (e.g., trigger phrase, keyboard shortcut trigger, language, voice style, etc) Note: If your device does not support Apple Intelligence, you will not see this category; instead you will see the Siri category
Desktop & Dock	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	- Resize the Dock - Set the Dock to hide automatically - Change the default web browser
Displays	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	- Rearrange or manage multiple displays (drag to change position, choose which is primary) - Adjust rotation (useful if you have a monitor mounted vertically) - Manage Night Shift (schedule, color temperature)
Menu Bar	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	- Choose items to include in the menu bar - Chose items that appear in Control Center
Spotlight	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	- Change the scope of content that appear in Spotlight search results Note: Spotlight helps you quickly find things on your device and shows suggestions from the Internet, Music, App Store, etc.

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Wallpaper	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	• Change your desktop background
Notifications	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Specify when you don't want to be disturbed by notifications • Control how notifications are shown in Notification Center • This settings category allows you to control the behavior of notifications at the app level; i.e., if an app supports notifications, you will find an entry for that app in this settings category control panel
Sound	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Manage sound effects • Adjust your audio output and input preferences
Sounds	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Manage sound effects • Adjust your audio output and input preferences
Sounds & Haptics	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Manage sound effects & haptic feedback • Adjust your audio output and input preferences
Focus	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Create Focus profiles that can minimize distractions by pausing and silencing all notifications or allowing notifications only from certain people or apps • When you need to stay on task and minimize distractions, use Focus. You can use a Focus to pause and silence all notifications or allow only certain notifications—for example, ones from colleagues on an urgent project. You can also share that you've silenced notifications so contacts know you're busy.
Screen Time	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Turn Screen Time on or off • Set parental controls for a child's device, including app limits, content and web access, and approval requests • Set a Screen Time passcode
Lock Screen	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Control if/when your device will revert to the lock screen after a period of inactivity • Chose which related controls are included on the lock screen
Privacy & Security	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓	• Control which apps can use your camera, mic, location, etc • Mac Only: Enable or disable FileVault (disk encryption)
Touch ID & Password	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	• Change a login password (on Mac) or passcode (on iPad & iPhone) • Add fingerprints (for biometric authentication) • Enable Apple Watch unlock
Face ID/Touch ID & Passcode	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓	• Change a login password (on Mac) or passcode (on iPad & iPhone) • Add fingerprints or faces (for biometric authentication)
Users & Groups	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Manage your Mac user accounts • Create and delete individual user accounts • Associate user accounts with privilege groups (not generally useful for consumer users; primarily used by corporate/business users)
Internet Accounts	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Add & delete your internet accounts from Google, Microsoft, Yahoo, etc, so that you can use those accounts in your Mac apps • Per account, select account features you want to use (mail, contacts, calendars, and notes)
Emergency SOS	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• In an emergency, you can use your iPhone to quickly/easily call for help, share your Medical ID, and alert your emergency contacts • This settings category contains controls that allow you • Define the button(s) that trigger an emergency call • Trigger your iPhone to make an emergency call if you are in a “severe” auto accident • Define who your emergency contacts are
Game Center	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Game Center is a social gaming service that lets you interact with others in online multiplayer games.

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iCloud	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓	• View how your iCloud Drive storage utilization • View which apps are saving data to your iCloud Drive • Enable/disable apps ability to save data to your iCloud Drive • Turn on/off “Advanced Data Protection” (i.e., end-to-end encryption of data stored in iCloud)
Wallet & Apply Pay	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Manage payment details • Add & remove a debit or credit card
Keyboard	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Set keyboard shortcuts • Adjust your keyboard’s backlighting • Add layouts for typing in other languages • Set up Dictation
Mouse	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Control the behaviors of mice you connect (via Bluetooth or USB) to your Mac • Behavior you can control are tracking speed, secondary click button, double-click speed, and scrolling speed
Trackpad	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Turn gestures (like swipe between desktops) on or off • Adjust click sensitivity
Printers & Scanners	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	• Choose a default printer (if you have more than one printer defined/connected) • Add additional printers/scanners • Access a printer/scanner’s controls (which will vary/depend on the printer/scanner itself; ie, different printers/scanners will have different setting controls)
Apps	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	• App settings controls panels are access inside this group • You can also chose default apps for mail, messaging, calling, browser, etc